Since continuous integration is a foundational practice of continuous delivery, the combination is often referred to as CI/CD. As a consequence, deployment pipelines are often called CI/CD pipelines. I have some reservations about the term, because continuous integration is not the only practice included in the continuous delivery discipline. For example, test-driven development (TDD), automated configuration management, acceptance testing, and continuous learning are equally important.

The *CI/CD* term is not used by Jez Humble and Dave Farley in their *Continuous Delivery* book, nor in any other book they have written on the subject. Also, it can be confusing. Does *CD* stand for *continuous delivery* or *continuous deployment*? In this book, I will refer to the holistic approach of delivering "better software faster"[a] as *continuous delivery* rather than CI/CD.

[a] D. Farley, *Continuous Delivery Pipelines*, 2021.

1.4.3 DevOps

DevOps is another of those buzzwords that are pretty popular these days but too often misunderstood. When shifting to cloud native, DevOps is an important concept to grasp.

The origins of DevOps are peculiar. One of the curious aspects is that the creators of this concept didn't initially provide a definition. The result was that several people used their own interpretations and, of course, we ended up using DevOps to mean different things.

NOTE If you're interested in knowing more about the origins of DevOps, I suggest watching the Ken Mugrage talks available on YouTube: "DevOps and DevOpsDays—Where it started, where it is, where it's going" (http://mng.bz/Ooln).

Among all the definitions of DevOps, I find the one proposed by Ken Mugrage (principal technologist at ThoughtWorks) to be particularly informative and interesting. He highlights what I believe is the true meaning of DevOps.